NDCS

THE NATIONAL DEAF CHILDREN'S SOCIETY

The National Deaf Children's Society

Corporate Identity and Housestyle Guidelines

Why do we have a corporate identity

A consistent identity makes an organisation easily recognisable and strengthens its reputation.

Our printed materials and website are some of the main ways our work is seen, which is why it is vital that they follow the NDCS corporate identity.

Ultimately, we can do more to improve opportunities for deaf children if our materials are consistently and attractively branded.

NDCS messages

By clearly and consistently expressing the needs of deaf children and young people and our services for them and their families, we can communicate more effectively with our various audiences: the families themselves; professionals working with them; and supporters.

NDCS messages are in the general leaflet.

Both the printed leaflet and the wording in Word format are available through the Communications office and can be used in other documents.

The Communications team can also advise on appropriate messages for particular audiences.

The four elements of the NDCS corporate identity

Our logo

Logo size

The size of the logo should be judged according to the size and design of the publication.

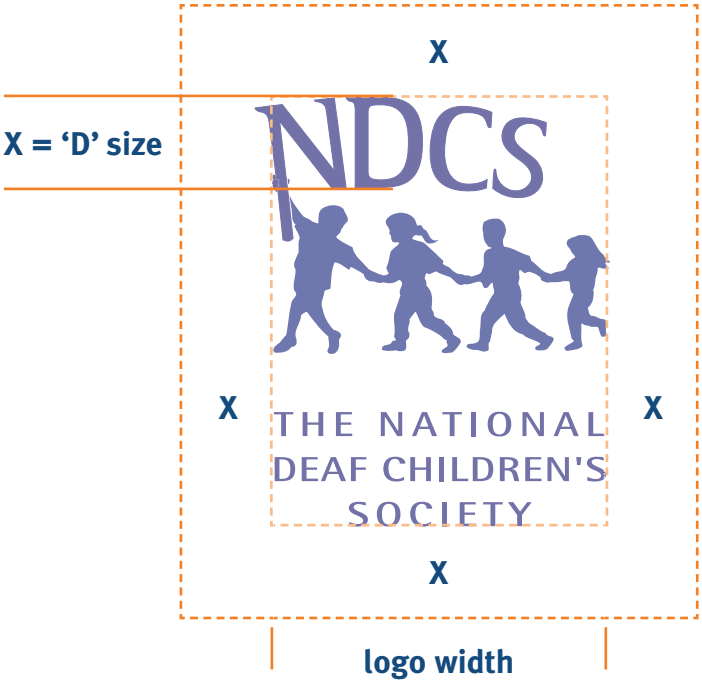
The size is determined by the maximum width of the title text.

The minimum size of the logo is 11mm wide.

Clear space

There should be a minimum 'exclusion zone' around the logo known as clear space. No other elements should enter this clear space.

The clear space is determined by the measure shown as 'x' and is equivalent to the height of the letter 'D' in the NDCS flag.



Logo colours

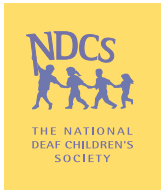
The NDCS logo should be printed in **amethyst** where the background is straw, mint, sky or white.

It should **white** where the background is amethyst, marine, pumpkin or midnight.

If you are restricted to black it can be printed in black or white out of black.

The colour for the **IDCS** logo is midnight.

Amethyst on:


straw

mint

sky

white

White out of:

amethyst

pumpkin

marine

midnight

Black only:

black

white

Logo positioning

The prefered position for the NDCS logo on the front of any publication is either in the **top right corner** or the **bottom right corner**.

Other positions are allowed if the layout restricts positioning options or if it enhances the overall design.

Our typeface

The NDCS font

The NDCS house font for externally produced materials is **Meta.** It should also be used for materials produced in-house that have a significant external audience (see 'Materials produced in-house' for further details). The different "weights" for Meta should be used to differentiate between major headings, body text, captions and other elements of a document.

If you are producing something that is part of a series, you and your designer should consider using the font that has been used on previous parts of the series for consistency. This should be discussed with the print production coordinator.

Type size

The NDCS's policy is to consider the needs of people with visual impairment. Therefore **type size should normally be no smaller than 12 point** and attention should be paid to colour schemes that maximise the legibility of type. The full **RNIB guidelines for print and electronic materials** are available from the Communications office.

abcdefgh

Meta Book
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

Meta Book Italic
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

Meta Medium
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

Meta Medium Italic
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

Meta Bold
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

Meta Bold Italic
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

Meta Black
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

Meta Black Italic
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

Our colours

The NDCS colour palette

These are the NDCS house colours and the permissable tints to use:

amethyst	Pantone: **667**	Process: c52 m49 y0 k14	30%	50%	70%
pumpkin	Pantone: **158**	Process: c0 m61 y97 k0	30%	50%	70%
marine	Pantone: **549**	Process: c52 m0 y6 k25	30%	50%	70%
sky	Pantone: **277**	Process: c27 m7 y0 k0		50%	70%
mint	Pantone: **345**	Process: c38 m0 y32 k0		50%	70%
straw	Pantone: **121**	Process: c0 m11 y69 k0		50%	70%
midnight	Pantone: **534**	Process: c100 m80 y30 k5	30%	50%	70%

Amethyst is the major colour for NDCS and should be used on the face of all materials.

One or both of either **pumpkin** and **marine** should be used in addition.

Other colours from the palette can be used in addition as appropriate for the publication.

Except for IDCS, **midnight** should only be used for type and should be used for body text in preference to black.

Designers should be made aware that colour splits given in some publishing software may differ and that only the specifications shown here are to be used.

Aside from any colours showing in a colour photograph or in illustrations, these are the only colours that should be used. The only exception is for **challenge events materials** which have a separate brand identity.

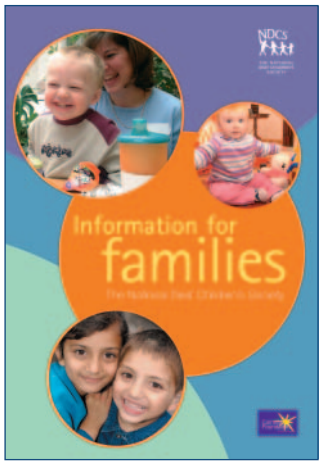
For IDCS, the major colour is midnight and this should show on the face of all IDCS materials.

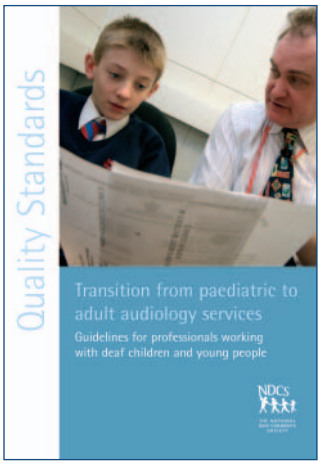
The colours as printed on this document may not be completely true and should not be used for colour proofing purposes. Please check with the print production coordinator.

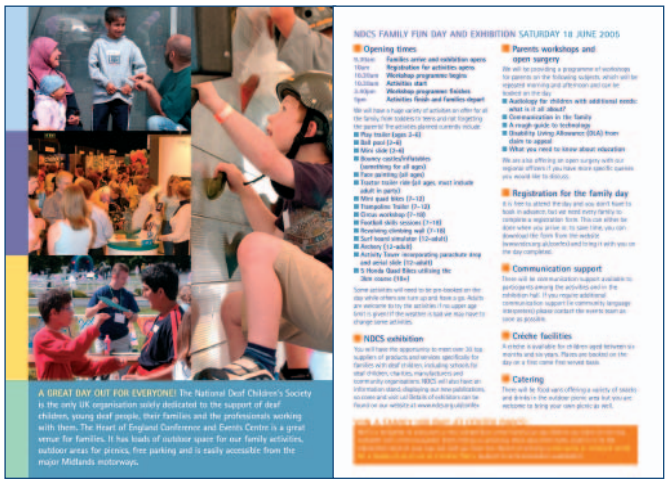
Our design style

Generally the NDCS look is **colourful**, **bright**, **positive** and **bold**.

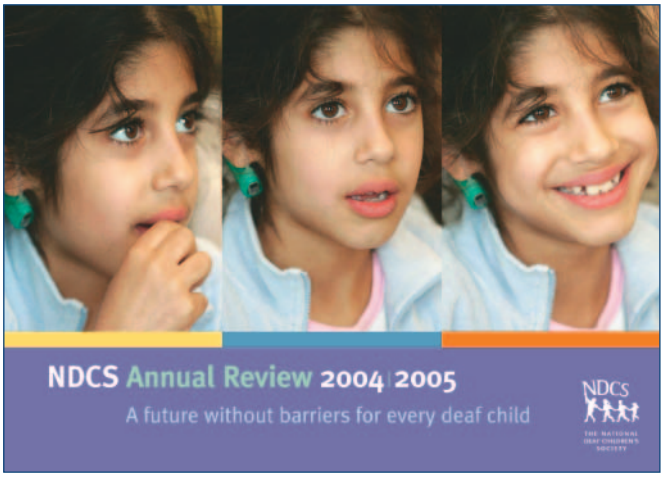
Publications targetted at **families and children** should utilize a wide range of colours from the colour palette whereas those targetted at **professionals** may use a more restricted and sombre selection. Ask the print production coordinator for further advice.







Layouts should be well constructed with an evident use of geometric shapes either as design devices ie containing type or images, or as abstract background elements to create visual interest. These elements should be bold and clean-edged and tonally the colours should be predominantly flat.



Backgrounds and pictures should bleed off of the page whenever possible. White backgrounds can work in conjunction with colourful areas to give balance and help pace the layout ie text-heavy pages.

The use of good **photographs** is a very powerful way to convey our message and you are encouraged to include them in most printed materials. Images should be positive and people-biased whenever possible and should be cropped to create greatest impact.

NDCS's policy in the use of photographs is:

- to show children with a range of ages and ethnicity
- to show a variety of methods of communication used by deaf people, for example: hearing aids, signing, cochlear implants.

Our housestyle

Every publisher has its own housestyle and the NDCS is no exception.

Here are the most important elements.

Firstly, terminology about deafness:

- The NDCS uses the term 'deaf' to mean all types of deafness, including temporary deafness such as glue ear
- The word 'deaf' is positive. Do not use words that define deaf people as victims, such as 'Amy suffers from deafness'
- Negative phrases such as 'deaf and dumb', 'deaf mute' or 'stone deaf' should never be used
- Write: 'deaf people', rather than 'the deaf'

Other important elements are:

- When writing 'the National Deaf Children's Society', or abbreviating it to 'the NDCS', 'the' should have a lower case 't' (except when it appears at the beginning of a sentence).
- The NDCS is singular (an organization), so write: The NDCS is taking part in....
- Clip art is not permitted and neither is wordart
- Dates should be written like this: 23 January 2005
- And times, amounts and measurements like this: 4pm, 9.30am (using the 12 hour clock) 6km, 20kg, £2m, £3, 20mm
- Use capital letters minimally: in headings, other than in the main heading of a publication, only the first letter and any proper noun should be in capitals; in job titles only when applied to a specific person's name. Write: the finance manager prepares the accounts; but Jane Foreman, Director of Finance and Administration.
- Numbers up to ten should be written in words (seven). Numbers bigger than ten in figures (29). Where you have both types in one sentence, choose one method or the other – don't mix them.

Paper

We recommend using either a 'silk' finish coated stock or a 'matt' uncoated stock.

An environmentally friendly paper should be used wherever practicable.

Publications will often need to use a variety of weights. We suggest that the minimum weight for text pages is 115gsm and for cover weights a minimum of 200gsm.

The full housestyle is available at:

S:\Global Shares\Communications\Corporate ID\Housestyle Handbook

Materials produced in-house

- The typeface **Meta** should be used for all documents professionally designed and for any produced in-house that have a significant external audience. This would include factsheets, newsletters and event materials. It may include other materials and this should be discussed with the print production coordinator who will supply the font and explain how to install and use it.
- For everything else the typeface **Arial** should be used.
- To achieve consistency in letters, faxes, reports and memos, the NDCS has developed templates. These should be used for most purposes. They are available in Word on everyone's computers. Contact the print production coordinator for advice on their use.

Our resources

Print guidelines

Guidelines for producing NDCS printed materials can be obtained from the print production coordinator. These include scheduling, preparing a design brief, obtaining prices, recommending printers and designers, and proofing.

We advise staff on planning and costing publications including help with thinking through what is needed and why.

Photo library

The NDCS has a well stocked electronic photo library which is administered by the Communications team. Procedures for using the library are available.

Consent has to be obtained for use of photos so you need to allow enough time for this to be sought (normally two weeks). If you use photos that are not in this library, you still have to get consent for use of pictures of people, especially of children. This is a legal requirement.

Case studies

The Communications team also looks after a database of case studies. These are very useful for bringing life to your text. **Again, permission has to be sought so please allow sufficient time for this to be done.**

Other resources available include:

- Powerpoint presentations template
- NDCS logo in different formats
- NDCS folders for use in training events, conferences or sending out documents
- Pop up stands and banners for conferences or exhibitons
- Headed stationery and business cards
- Templates that should be used for office documents such as letters, faxes and reports. These are available in Word on everyone's computers. Contact the print production coordinator for advice on their use.

Checklist

The following should be on every document:

1. NDCS logo
2. www.ndcs.org.uk
3. Registered charity no. 1016532
4. Date of publication
5. Contact details:
   these will vary according to the specific publication – the general leaflet shows the correct form of NDCS office contacts.

NDCS

THE NATIONAL DEAF CHILDREN'S SOCIETY

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Registered Charity No 1016532

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